

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's learn about the origin of the Olympics!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about leisure time, culture and sports.
- I can describe people, events or things.
- I can report facts about events and actions.

Ask your partner:

- What do you know about the Olympic Games?
- What's the highest level at which you have competed at sports?





Let's Explore!

Competing **in the buff***.

* To be "*in the buff*" means to be naked.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Did you know that the first Olympic Games took place in Greece in 776 BC? That's a pretty long time ago! The games included events such as racing, boxing, horse racing, and long jumping. They were held every four years, and only amateur athletes were included. It has been said that some events in the present-day Olympic Games can be a bit boring. Modern spectators would experience a number of confusing emotions watching the ancient games, but they certainly wouldn't feel bored. First of all, the games would be quite shocking, as the athletes competed completely nude. Wouldn't you be shocked to see a unclothed boxing bout? Some might find it particularly disgusting to know that athletes covered themselves in olive oil before competing. A contemporary onlooker might also feel confused, because the rules governing the ancient events would be much different than their modern counterparts (some events were contested to the death, for example). Lastly, most people would certainly be more than a little bit disgusted to find that women were forbidden from participating or even watching.

The athletes with the most inspiring performances of the Olympic Games were treated as heroic idols and were mentioned in songs and poems. However, when the games started turning into professional games, they lost their popularity.

In 396 AD, the Olympic Games were stopped by the Roman emperor. They were not continued until 1896 when the modern Olympic Games began once more in Athens, Greece. The modern Olympic Games were held every four years until 1994. Nowadays, they are held every two years, alternating between summer and winter games. Another change that started in the early 90s is that in some cases, professional athletes were allowed to participate.



Let's Practice!

Ancient Olympic Games were not boring.

Instructions: Unscramble the words in order to find the mystery sentence. Write the sentences correctly. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- Olympic Games / boring. / can be / in the / Some events / present-day /

- bored. / wouldn't / spectators / Modern / feel

- a clothesless / It might / boxing bout./ be shocking /to see

- that women/ to find / feel disgusted / People would / from participating. / were forbidden

- Inspiring / mentioned / performances / were / songs. / in



Let's Practice!

Here are some interesting facts about the ancient Olympic Games.

Instructions: Complete the sentences with the options you are given in the word bank. There are four options you don't need to use. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

- spectators
- counterpart
- amateur
- competing
- contemporary
- bout
- onlooker
- present – day
- idols

- One particular thing about ancient Olympic Games is that only _____ athletes were included.
- _____ at the event were only men.
- _____ onlookers would experience confusing emotions seeing the athletes nude.
- It might be shocking to see a clothesless boxing _____.
- Athletes in ancient Olympic Games were treated as _____.



Extension Activity

An Olympic recap.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research a past Olympic Games.
- Make a medal chart highlighting which countries won the most medals. Include your country.
- Highlight the best individual performances of the games.
- Present the results to your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research past events.

☐ ☐

I make a rankings chart.

☐ ☐

I highlight inspiring performances.

☐ ☐

I share my findings with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **amateur** (adjective): describes an athlete who is not professional
e.g. They were held every four years, and only amateur athletes were included.
- **spectator** (noun): a person who watches an activity or event
e.g. Modern spectators would experience a number of confusing emotions watching the ancient games.
- **onlooker** (noun): someone who watches what is happening
e.g. A contemporary onlooker might also feel confused, because the rules governing the ancient events would be much different.
- **bout** (noun): a match or combat
e.g. Wouldn't you be shocked to see a clothesless boxing bout?
- **to compete** (verb): to try to win a sporting activity or event
e.g. Some might find it particularly disgusting to know that athletes covered themselves in olive oil before competing.
- **counterpart** (noun): something that has the same purpose as something else in a different place
e.g. The ancient events would be much different than their modern counterparts.
- **idol** (noun): a person who is very respected or admired
e.g. The athletes with the most inspiring performances at the Olympic Games were treated as heroic idols.





Learning Points

Adjectives to Describe Feelings and Character Traits.

You use adjectives to describe the feelings and characteristics of a person.

Adjectives ending in **-ing** are used to describe the characteristics of a person, thing or situation.

Adjectives ending in **-ed** are used to describe the feelings or emotions of a person.

Adjectives ending in **-ed** can only be used to describe feelings or emotions. They describe how a person feels. They cannot be used to describe an object or situation.

Adjectives ending in **-ing** can be used either with a person or a situation. They describe the characteristics of a person or a situation. They also describe how a situation makes you feel.

Compare the differences:

- John is bored. (John feels bored.)
- John is boring. (John is a boring person.)
- The movie is boring. (The movie causes people to feel bored)

You cannot say the movie is bored, since the subject is not a person.

Example:

- I was **shocked** by how **shocking** the accident was yesterday.
- John was **confused** by the **confusing** street signs in the city.
- This gym class is **tiring**. I feel really **tired** right now.
- The speech was really **inspiring**! I feel **inspired** to do more with my life now.

Examples:

- The games would be quite **shocking**, as the athletes competed completely nude.
- Wouldn't you be **shocked** to see a unclothed boxing bout?





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive

You use the active voice when you want the 'doer' of the action to be the subject.
You use the **passive voice** when you want the 'receiver' of the action to be the subject.

Take a look at this:

Active sentence:

- **The Romans** (subject) *stopped* the **Olympic Games** (object) in 396 AD.

Passive sentence:

- **The Olympic Games** (subject) **were stopped** by **the Romans** (object) in 396 AD.

It is not always necessary to mention the object in a passive sentence.

Example: *My car was stolen.*

You make the passive form of a verb by using tenses of the **be** verb followed by the past participle.

The Simple Present passive form is:

is/are + past participle

For example:

- *The Olympic Games **are celebrated** every four years.*
- *Professional athletes **are allowed** to participate in the modern Olympic Games.*

You use the Simple Present passive to talk about a situation that goes on in the present.

The Simple Past passive form is:

was/were + past participle

For example:

- *The Olympic Games **were resumed** in 1896 in Greece.*
- *The Games **were held** every 4 years until 1994.*

You use the Simple Past passive to talk about a situation that is finished.

Examples:

- *Women were forbidden from participating or even watching.*
- *In 396 AD, the Olympic Games were stopped by the Roman emperor.*

